incline, might cause a problem for your car. And worse, if the car were to then slow down to 29 kmph, it would go back to the second gear. Accelerate a little and it'll shift back to third. The problem with having a set integer – of 30, in this case – is that it doesn't allow for an "intelligent" way of driving even though it's a logical way of driving.


The self-driving AutoNOMOS car in action

Fuzzy logic systems are installed in automatic transition gear boxes to make your car more intelligent. The car won't just jump from the second gear to the third at a set integer. Instead, it accounts for the "fuzzy" area of logic to ensure that your car changes gear smartly and not based on a mathematical Boolean case of "yes" or "no" to the 30 mark.

Fuzzy logic is used in most modern artificial intelligence units.

Autonomous cars

The idea of a truly "intelligent" system is perhaps best represented in the form of self-driving cars and aircraft.

It has been many years since scientists have started working on cars that drive themselves. But only recently have the advances come to a point where it's considered safe to test these "autonomous vehicles" in real-world settings.

For a few years, America's DARPA (Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency) organised an annual race for such cars, but the last